

Whistleblowing Policy

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Approved by	Board Audit Committee
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1. Purpose

Veridane Bank wants people to speak up when they suspect wrongdoing. Early reporting protects customers, staff, and the bank. This policy explains what to report, how to report it, how reports are handled, and how the bank protects people who report.

2. Who Can Use This Policy

- current and former staff members, including interns;
- contractors, consultants, and vendor staff;
- customers and shareholders;
- anyone else with information about wrongdoing connected to the bank.

3. What to Report

Report any genuine concern about:

- fraud, theft, or embezzlement, whether by staff, customers, or third parties;
- bribery or corruption;
- money laundering, terrorist financing, or sanctions breaches;
- breaches of law, regulation, or bank policy;
- manipulation or falsification of records, including financial statements;
- harassment, discrimination, or bullying;
- misuse of customer data;
- risks to health, safety, or the environment;
- retaliation against someone who raised a concern;
- deliberate concealment of any of the above.

3.1 What this policy is not for

Issue	Where to go
A personal grievance about pay, performance ratings, or working conditions	The HR grievance procedure, through the HR Service Center (ext. 4200)

Issue	Where to go
A customer complaint about service	The complaints procedure in a branch or through the DFS Contact Center
A suspicious transaction on a customer's own card, wallet, or account	The Fraud Desk, 24/7, on 0800 555 0177 or 0800 555 0178

If a grievance or complaint also reveals wrongdoing, for example a manager falsifying records, it should be reported under this policy.

4. Reasonable Belief

You do not need proof. Report if you honestly and reasonably believe that wrongdoing has happened, is happening, or is likely to happen. Do not investigate on your own, confront the people involved, or gather evidence by accessing systems or records you would not normally use for your job.

5. How to Report

5.1 Reporting channels

Channel	Details
Speak Up Line (phone)	0800 555 0199, toll-free, 24/7, run independently by ClearLine Assurance
Speak Up web portal	speakup.veridane.example, 24/7
Email	whistleblowing@veridane.example, received by the Whistleblowing Unit in Compliance
Letter	Chief Compliance Officer, 14 Admiralty Crescent, Port Halden, marked "Strictly Private and Confidential"
Board Audit Committee Chair	bac.chair@veridane.example

5.2 Concerns about senior management

If a concern involves the CCO, the CEO, or any other EXCO member, report it directly to the Chair of the Board Audit Committee. These reports are not seen by Compliance or management.

5.3 Reporting to a line manager

Staff may also raise a concern with their line manager. A manager who receives a concern must pass it to the Whistleblowing Unit within 1 business day, and must not investigate it or discuss it with anyone else.

5.4 External reporting

Nothing in this policy prevents anyone from reporting directly to the Central Monetary Authority, the Financial Intelligence Bureau, another regulator, or law enforcement.

6. Anonymity and Confidentiality

- Reports can be made anonymously through the Speak Up Line or the web portal. ClearLine Assurance gives the reporter a case number and a PIN, which they use to check progress and answer follow-up questions without revealing who they are.
- If a whistleblower gives their name, it is shared only with the people who need it to handle the case, and only with the whistleblower's consent, unless the law requires disclosure.
- Anyone who tries to identify an anonymous whistleblower faces disciplinary action under VB-POL-004.

7. Protection from Retaliation

7.1 The bank will not tolerate retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith, even if the concern turns out to be mistaken. Retaliation includes dismissal, demotion, loss of promotion or bonus, unfavorable transfer, harassment, exclusion, and threats.

7.2 Retaliation is gross misconduct under VB-POL-004.

7.3 A whistleblower who believes they have suffered retaliation should report it through any channel in section 5. The CCO personally reviews every retaliation claim, or the BAC Chair does so if the claim involves the CCO.

7.4 For 24 months after a named report, HR must consult the CCO before taking any disciplinary action, giving a negative performance rating, or approving a transfer that affects the whistleblower.

7.5 Knowingly making a false report is misconduct and is handled under VB-POL-004. This policy does not protect a whistleblower from the consequences of their own wrongdoing, although reporting it voluntarily is taken into account.

8. How Reports Are Handled

8.1 Timelines

Step	Timeline
Acknowledgment to the reporter	Within 2 business days of receipt
Preliminary assessment by the Whistleblowing Unit	Within 10 business days of receipt
Investigation	Target completion within 60 days of the preliminary assessment
Progress updates to the reporter	At least every 30 days while the case is open
Outcome feedback to the reporter	Within 10 business days of case closure

8.2 Routing

After the preliminary assessment, the Whistleblowing Unit routes each case:

- suspected money laundering, terrorist financing, or sanctions breaches go to the MLRO;
- suspected fraud goes to the Head of Fraud Risk Management, working with Internal Audit;
- misuse of personal data goes to the DPO;
- harassment and discrimination go to HR, with Compliance oversight;
- matters involving an EXCO member are investigated by external investigators appointed by the BAC Chair.

8.3 Independence

No one named in a report, or who reports to someone named in it, may take part in the investigation.

8.4 Feedback

The whistleblower is told whether the concern was substantiated and, where possible, what action was taken. Details of disciplinary action against other people are not shared.

9. Oversight and Record Keeping

- The Whistleblowing Unit keeps a confidential register of all reports.

- The CCO reports to the Board Audit Committee every quarter. The report covers the number of reports, their categories and channels, time to close, and outcomes, and contains no names.
- Internal Audit reviews how well the whistleblowing arrangements work every year.
- Case records are kept for 7 years after the case is closed.

10. Awareness and Training

- New staff learn about this policy during induction.
- Managers complete a course on receiving concerns every two years.
- Speak Up Line posters are displayed in every branch staff area and at head office.

11. Related Documents

- VB-ORG-001 Company Profile and Policy Framework
- VB-POL-003 Data Protection and Privacy Policy
- VB-POL-004 Ethics and Code of Conduct Policy
- VB-POL-006 Internal Control Policy
- VB-POL-007 Know Your Customer and Know Your Customer's Business Policy

Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of changes
3.2	2026-01-15	Added PIN-based follow-up for anonymous reports. Protection period for named whistleblowers extended from 12 to 24 months.
3.1	2025-02-01	Investigations involving EXCO members moved to external investigators appointed by the BAC Chair.